

DayFrame — Project North Star (Draft)

Mission

DayFrame helps people understand their obligations, reveal their available capacity, and intentionally allocate their time toward what matters most.

The Problem

Most calendar applications answer:

"What am I doing?"

Most task managers answer:

"What should I do next?"

Most project management systems answer:

"What work exists?"

Very few tools answer:

"Given the life I actually have, what is realistically possible?"

People often know what they must do:

- Work
- Sleep
- Classes
- Appointments
- Family obligations
- Administrative tasks

The challenge is understanding what remains after those obligations are accounted for, and then using that remaining time intentionally.

Core Philosophy

DayFrame operates on a simple principle:

Obligations First. Opportunities Second.

Before meaningful planning can occur, the system must accurately model reality.

Reality includes:

- Work schedules
- Sleep requirements
- Recurring commitments
- Manual events
- Family obligations
- Personal maintenance

Only after those commitments are represented can meaningful decisions be made about how to spend remaining time.

What DayFrame Is

DayFrame is a capacity and prioritization engine that uses scheduling as its primary mechanism.

Its purpose is not merely to store events.

Its purpose is to help users understand:

- What must happen
- What could happen
- What should happen

within the finite time available to them.

Long-Term Vision

DayFrame should eventually help users answer questions such as:

- How much discretionary time do I actually have?
- Am I overcommitted?
- What goals fit into my current life?
- Which projects are competing for the same time?
- What am I neglecting?
- What deserves more attention?

The system should make invisible constraints visible and transform time from something that feels scarce and reactive into something that can be intentionally allocated.

Fundamental Concepts

Commitments

Things that must happen.

Examples:

- Work shifts
 - Classes
 - Meetings
 - Appointments
 - Family obligations
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Patterns

Reusable structures that describe recurring reality.

Examples:

- DDNNOO
 - Pitman
 - Dupont
 - Semesters
 - Rotating schedules
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Goals

Things that should happen but are not tied to a fixed time.

Examples:

- Writing
 - Exercise
 - Learning
 - Side projects
 - Business development
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Capacity

Available time remaining after commitments are accounted for.

Capacity is the resource users are ultimately managing.

Product Principle

The calendar is not the product.

The calendar is the visualization.

The product is helping people understand their lives well enough to make deliberate decisions about how they spend their limited time.

Success Metric

A successful DayFrame user should be able to answer:

"I know what I must do."

"I know what time I have available."

"I know what deserves that time."

And then act accordingly.